Improving the Renewal Process: A Collaborative Discussion on Pricing and Project Management

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Condensed summary
A gap was identified in how renewal deals update existing projects and pricing in Salesforce and the downstream platform. The team discussed current workflows for new business versus renewals, legacy pricing exceptions, and manual interventions by support. A solution was proposed to tag affected projects with the renewal opportunity, automate pricing updates, and tighten communication until full automation is in place.

Detailed breakdown

📋 Background
- meeting convened to address a gap in the renewal process
- example case: SentinelOne closed-won didn't flow updated pricing to the platform
- support team failed to update old pricing, leading to invoicing errors

🔍 Current renewal and upsell workflows
- new business: closed-won opportunity automatically creates Salesforce project and platform project via Workato
- upsell: similar flow but must detect existing entities to avoid duplicate projects
- renewal: closed-won deal does not create projects, only triggers manual pricing updates by AM and support

⚙️ How pricing is pulled today
- platform project ID matched to Salesforce project by ID
- opportunity subscription line items fetched programmatically
- service, account, country filters applied to select relevant line items
- works flawlessly for brand-new projects, fails on renewals

❌ Identified gaps
- no process to identify which existing projects are impacted by a renewal opportunity
- pricing and opportunity ID on project object remain tied to original deal
- legacy pricing exceptions for 2023–24 complicate automated

updates
- manual support updates prone to errors and billing reissues
- ambiguous logic around upsell vs. new entity creation

💡 Proposed solution outline
- introduce logic on renewal close-won to:
  - detect affected projects for that account and service
  - update project's opportunity ID or set "renewed by" field to new opportunity
  - trigger automated pricing update based on new opportunity rates
- use existing fields (opportunity product, subscription) to preserve original source if needed
- flag each project as renewed and link to renewal deal for auditability

🤔 Business considerations and edge cases
- legacy pricing honored for select customers (must not override)
- upsell of existing country vs. new entity distinction
- upsell vs. renewal must be separated in Salesforce: separate record types or deal type field
- some AMs bundle renewals and upsells in one document—requires clear separation
- rare cases of same country "new project" need project creation even on upsell

🛠️ Technical considerations
- modify Workato and Salesforce logic to:
  - check deal type and record type for upsell vs. renewal
  - identify existing project by service/account/country combination
  - update project opportunity reference or a custom "renewal" checkbox
- ensure downstream support case creation still triggers for manual overrides as interim

👥 Roles and responsibilities
- sales/AMs: correctly classify opportunity as new, upsell, or renewal; list impacted entities
- R&D/Dev (Ben's team): implement logic in Salesforce and update Workato flows
- support: audit and apply interim manual updates; notify AMs of discrepancies
- integration lead (Muhammad): adjust project-pricing API calls as needed

🚧 Short-term risk mitigation
- until automation is live, AMs to explicitly notify support of renewal deals and projects needing updates
- introduce a simple manual checklist or email trigger for support on each renewal close-won

📅 Next steps and action items
- write detailed process spec capturing new logic and edge cases
- review spec with Ben's team to gap-check technical feasibility
- align with support team on interim manual notification flow
- schedule follow-up meeting to confirm implementation timeline

Conclusions
- root cause: no link between renewal opportunities and existing projects, causing outdated pricing
- proposed fix: detect and tag affected projects at close-won, automate pricing updates, preserve legacy pricing where needed
- interim measure: stricter AM-support notification until end-to-end automation is deployed